



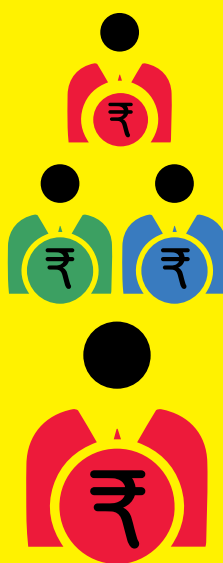
Testing Times

AS BYJU RAVEENDRAN tries to guide the world's most valuable edtech start-up to profitability, it will be a make-or-break year for BYJU'S. After two years of hyper growth on the pandemic-led digital boom, edtech start-ups have been facing their moment of reckoning. Layoffs are rampant in the sector—BYJU'S fired nearly 2,500 people. With a renewed focus on sustainability and capital-efficient growth, 2023 will be the year to watch out for.

OUTLOOK STILL CLOUDY

Paytm continues to struggle to convince investors about its business model. The company has given a guidance of becoming Ebitda-positive by the quarter ending September 2023. Is it on track to meet its objectives, or are there stumbling blocks? As a distributor, the company is banking on loan volumes, but the payments, investments, and other business lines have to fire to make profits. The odds seem quite dim now.

RICH PICKINGS



India's rich also reside in Tier II and III towns as PMS players are finding out to their delight. With significant inflows coming from Tier II and III towns, some leading PMS firms have seen over 40 per cent flows from such locations. The coming year will see PMS players further expand their client base to these areas as the number of affluent investors rises.



FAB-ULOUS DREAMS

WHILE IT WAS in December 2021 that the government approved the India Semiconductor Mission with a financial outlay of ₹76,000 crore, 2023 will be crucial for India's semiconductor journey. The year gone by witnessed tremendous progress with the government receiving some credible applications to set up semiconductor and display fabs. Now everyone is waiting for the government to announce the approved applicants, following which it will take around three to five years to plan and build commercial fabs.

